

DECENT COACHING CLASSES

Tenses

The Complete Guide

Present • Past • Future — Simple, Continuous, Perfect & Perfect Continuous

Class 2 | 4th August

For Classes VIII, IX & X — Maharashtra Board & NCERT

What is Tense?

"Tense" comes from the Latin word tempus, meaning time

V_1 V_2 V_3
 V_{ing} / V_4

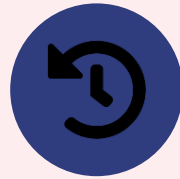


A verb changes its form to show WHEN an action, event or condition happens. There are 3 tenses, and each has 4 forms — giving us 12 tenses in total.



PRESENT

Now



PAST

Before now



FUTURE

After now

Each tense has 4 sub-forms:

Simple / Indefinite

Does NOT show whether the action is complete.

Perfect

Shows the action is complete, finished.

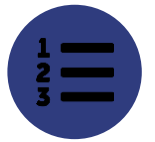
Continuous (Imperfect)

Shows the action is still going ON.

Perfect Continuous

Shows the action began in the past and is STILL continuing.

The Master Table — All 12 Tenses



Structure and example at a glance — keep this slide for revision

TENSE	STRUCTURE	EXAMPLE
Simple Present	<i>Sub + V1(+s/es) + Object</i>	<i>She writes a letter.</i>
Present Continuous	<i>Sub + is/am/are + V1+ing + Object</i>	<i>She is writing a letter.</i>
Present Perfect	<i>Sub + has/have + V3 + Object</i>	<i>She has written a letter.</i>
Present Perfect Continuous	<i>Sub + has/have + been + V1+ing + Object</i>	<i>She has been writing a letter.</i>
Simple Past	<i>Sub + V2 + Object</i>	<i>She wrote a letter.</i>
Past Continuous	<i>Sub + was/were + V1+ing + Object</i>	<i>She was writing a letter.</i>
Past Perfect	<i>Sub + had + V3 + Object</i>	<i>She had written a letter.</i>
Past Perfect Continuous	<i>Sub + had been + V1+ing + Object</i>	<i>She had been writing a letter.</i>
Simple Future	<i>Sub + will/shall + V1 + Object</i>	<i>She will write a letter.</i>
Future Continuous	<i>Sub + will/shall + be + V1+ing + Object</i>	<i>She will be writing a letter.</i>
Future Perfect	<i>Sub + will/shall + have + V3 + Object</i>	<i>She will have written a letter.</i>
Future Perfect Continuous	<i>Sub + will/shall + have been + V1+ing + Object</i>	<i>She will have been writing a letter.</i>

Simple Present

Scientific facts, universal truths, daily/habitual actions

The sun rises in the east



STRUCTURE: Sub + V1 (+s/es) + Object | Negative uses does/do not | Question starts with Does/Do

Assertive

She writes a letter.
They

Aux α The sun does not rise in the West

Negative

She does not write a letter.
They

He is a boy
Is he . . .

Interrogative

Does she write a letter?
Do They

Interrogative Negative

Does she not write a letter?

Present Continuous — Progressive

An action taking place exactly at the time of speaking



V₁ + ing

STRUCTURE: Sub + is/am/are + V₁ + ing + Object

Assertive

She is writing a letter.

She is writing
Riddhi loves singing

Negative

She is not writing a letter.

Interrogative

Is she writing a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Is she not writing a letter?

Present Perfect

An action that started in the past and has JUST finished

V₂

9 Plural



STRUCTURE: Sub + has/have + V3 + Object (has → singular, have → plural)

Assertive

She has written a letter.
↓
They

write wrote written
1 2 3

Negative

She has not written a letter.

Interrogative

Has she written a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Has she not written a letter?

Present Perfect Continuous

An action that started in the past and is STILL continuing now



STRUCTURE: Sub + has/have + been + V1+ing + Object

Assertive

She has been writing a letter.

Negative

She has not been writing a letter.

Interrogative

Has she been writing a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Has she not been writing a letter?

Simple Past

know knew know



An action completed in the past — often with a time adverb; also past habits

STRUCTURE: Sub + V2 + Object | Negative/Question use did + V1 (base form)

Assertive

She wrote a letter.

~~AXX~~

Negative

She ~~didn't~~ write a letter.

do / does

I didn't ~~knew~~ know

Interrogative

Did she write a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Did she not write a letter?

रहा रही



Past Continuous

An action that was going on at a specific moment in the past

STRUCTURE: Sub + was/were + V1+ing + Object

Assertive

She was writing a letter.

Negative

She was not writing a letter.

Interrogative

Was she writing a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Was she not writing a letter?

Past Perfect

युक्त शब्द



An action completed before another action/point in the past (the EARLIER of two past events)

STRUCTURE: Sub + had + V3 + Object

Assertive

She had written a letter.

Negative

She had not written a letter.

Interrogative

Had she written a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Had she not written a letter?

Past Perfect Continuous

An action that began before a point in the past and continued up to that point

Parag



STRUCTURE: Sub + had been + V1+ing + Object

Assertive

She had been writing a letter.

Negative

She had not been writing a letter.

Interrogative

Had she been writing a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Had she not been writing a letter?

Simple Future



An action that hasn't happened yet and will occur after this moment

STRUCTURE: Sub + will/shall + V1 + Object (Shall with I/We, Will with others — reversed for a promise, warning or emphasis)

Assertive

She will write a letter.

I will complete school

Negative

She will not write a letter.

Praneet shall
Praneet will

Interrogative

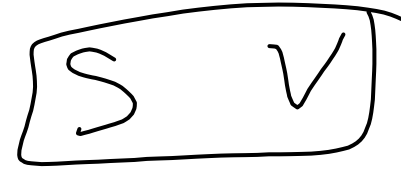
Will she write a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Will she not write a letter?

Future Continuous

An action that will be ongoing / in progress at a particular time in the future



STRUCTURE: Sub + will/shall + be + ^{V₁}V1+ing + Object

Assertive

She will be writing a letter.

Negative

She will not be writing a letter.

I shall be .

Interrogative

Will she be writing a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Will she not be writing a letter?

Future Perfect

An action that will be COMPLETED by a certain time in the future

Perf → V₃
Prog cont → V₄



STRUCTURE: Sub + will/shall + have + V₃ + Object

Assertive

She will have written a letter.

Negative

She will not have written a letter.

Interrogative

Will she have written a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Will she not have written a letter?

Future Perfect Continuous



An action that starts at a fixed future time and continues for a duration before another future event

STRUCTURE: Sub + will/shall + have been + V1+ing + Object

Assertive

She will have been writing a letter.

Negative

She will not have been writing a letter.

Interrogative

Will she have been writing a letter?

Interrogative Negative

Will she not have been writing a letter?

Practice — Fill in the Correct Tense



Complete Andrea's letter using the correct tense of the verb given in brackets

Shambhavi

Dear Christina, Many thanks for your letter. I am (be) very sorry I did not write (not write) for so long, but I was (be) very busy and we were have (have) exams at the end of the month. Anyway, you will be (be) pleased to hear the course went (go) really well. I liked (like) the teachers very much, and we also had (have) classes for British culture — they're really interesting. I practise (practise) pronunciation in the language lab and watching videos a lot too. I met (meet) lots of really nice people on the course and we all got on (get on) well together. We was (go out) to films and restaurants together, and we are organize (organize) trips to the country now and then. Last weekend we went (go) to Wales, which was (be) great. Next month we will go (go) to Cornwall. I'd better go now as I want (want) to catch the post.

Lots of love,

Andrea

Riddhi

Previous Year Questions



Tenses

Q1. Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb: "She ____ (write) a letter every day."

wrote

1 M

SB — 8

Q3. Identify the tense used: "He had left before I arrived."

Past Perf

1 M

SB — 10

Q5. Change into interrogative: "She has been working here for five years."

Has she been working here for five years?

1 M

SB — 8

Q2. Change into negative: "They are playing football."

not

1 M

CBSE — 9

Q4. Fill in the blank: "By next year, I ____ (complete) my graduation."

shall have

completed

2 M

CBSE — 10

Q6. Fill in the blank with the correct tense: "Water ____ (boil) at 100°C."

U.T.

Boils

1 M

CBSE — 8

Quick Recap



PRESENT

Simple (writes) · Continuous (is writing) · Perfect (has written) · Perfect Continuous (has been writing)



PAST

Simple (wrote) · Continuous (was writing) · Perfect (had written) · Perfect Continuous (had been writing)



FUTURE

Simple (will write) · Continuous (will be writing) · Perfect (will have written) · Perfect Continuous (will have been writing)

Being



Practice Makes Perfect!

Homework: complete the letter exercise and revise the Master Table before the next class.

Questions? Ask now!